

HONORABLE NOBLE DUKE LETO ATRIDES

DRIVE STATEMENT

DUTY: **8** My House, my family, and my people: all are one.

FAITH: **5**

JUSTICE: **7** Law must rule the people, but the heart must rule the law.

POWER: **4**

TRUTH: **6** Part of courage comes from extending our knowledge.

SKILL FOCUSES

BATTLE: **6**

COMMUNICATE: **7** Charm, Diplomacy, Empathy

DISCIPLINE: **7** Composure

MOVE: **5**

UNDERSTAND: **6** House Politics, Imperial Politics

Traits: Noble, Fair and Honorable

TALENTS:

- ☞ **Bolster:** Leto may spend 2 Threat to allow an ally to re-roll his dice pool. He may use Discipline instead of his skill.
- ☞ **Direct:** Once per scene, Leto can give an ally an extra action on his turn.
- ☞ **Stirring Rhetoric:** When Leto succeeds at a Communicate test to address a group, select a number of those people equal to his Communicate skill. They may re-roll a single d20 on their next test that aligns with the drive used on Leto's Communicate test.

History may only remember Duke Leto Atrides as the father of Paul, but the Duke was a most able man of an able time. Under his command the Atrides rose to such power and popularity amongst their peers as to threaten the Emperor himself.

Leto took up the dukedom while still a young man following the death of his father, Duke Paulus, in a bull-fighting accident. The young Duke was forced to take on the twin burdens of mourning his father and leading his House during a turbulent time. The early years of his reign on Caladan were marked by conflicts both subtle and overt with the age-old rivals of the Atrides, House Harkonnen. When the Bene Tleilax took control of Ix, Leto continued to give the Ixian House Vernius sanctuary despite the political damage it could potentially have done. Time and again, the Duke's choices led to both his increasing popularity in the Landsraad and the jealousy and suspicions of the Imperial throne.

The Duke was also noted for the company he kept. A superb judge of character, Leto gathered around him retainers and comrades who would prove to be among the most talented and insightful advisors gathered anywhere in the universe. That men such as Gurney Halleck and Duncan Idaho would follow the Duke was seen as a testament to his character.

Throughout these times Leto distinguished himself as a fair ruler, as concerned for his subjects as for the members of his own family. While he was rightly considered a just and good man, he was nevertheless remarkably pragmatic. Despite being utterly devoted to his love, the concubine Jessica, Leto never married her, shrewdly choosing to keep the possibility of marriage between himself and a noblewoman of another House as a bargaining incentive.

When the Emperor offered the Atrides the fiefdom of Arrakis and control of the spice, the Duke easily recognized it for the trap it was, but he took the gambit willingly, knowing that his duty as a leader of men required him to rise to meet even the deadliest challenge.



NOBLE CONSORT LADY JESSICA

DRIVE STATEMENT

DUTY:	7	The Sisterhood is my family.
FAITH:	8	Leto and my son are everything.
JUSTICE:	6	I will pay for my own mistakes.
POWER:	4	
TRUTH:	5	

SKILL FOCUSES

BATTLE:	6	Short Blades
COMMUNICATE:	6	Persuasion
DISCIPLINE:	7	Self-control
MOVE:	7	Body Control
UNDERSTAND:	6	Etiquette, Faction Lore (Bene Gesserit)

Traits: Consort, Bene Gesserit, Dedicated, and Devoted

TALENTS

- ☞ **Hyperawareness:** Whenever Jessica spends Threat to Obtain Information, she may know two pieces of information about a player character for each point spent. Further, the limits of what others would be able to notice do not apply to her.
- ☞ **Passive Scrutiny:** When Jessica enters a scene, she may know one piece of hidden information as if she'd spent Threat to Obtain Information.
- ☞ **Prana-Bindu:** Jessica can re-roll 1d20 on a Move or Discipline test.
- ☞ **Voice:** Jessica can spend up to 3 points of Threat to buy automatic successes on a Communicate test (1 success/point).

Jessica was born to be a small cog in a vast plan, but through a single act of disobedience she put in motion the fall of the Imperium.

Raised by the Bene Gesserit, Jessica was groomed from childhood to be a tool of their breeding plan. Tutoed in all but the deepest mysteries of the Sisterhood, Jessica was an exemplary member of the order. Brilliant, insightful, and possessed of a deep calm even in the face of peril, she was as well-suited to her assigned role as the Bene Gesserit could have dreamed.

Jessica's superiors carefully maneuvered to have Duke Leto of House Atreides choose her as a concubine. This placement was critical. Almost superficially, it was important for the Bene Gesserit to have an agent at the heart of House Atreides, but more crucially, she was ordered to bear the Duke a daughter that the Sisterhood could see married to a Harkonnen, not just mending the ancient enmity between those Houses, but bearing the Kwisatz Haderach. This super-being would then be under the direct control of the Bene Gesserit and bring to fruition millennia of plans.

It should have been a simple endeavor, but for one problem: Jessica fell in love with the Duke, who returned her feelings. Unusually for a Bene Gesserit, Jessica refused to ignore her emotions and do as she was told. Knowing that Leto wanted a son as an heir she chose to bear a boy rather than a girl as her first child. The Sisterhood was livid but could do little. With typical pragmatism they decided that they could wait a few more years for Jessica to bear a daughter as well. However, her actions nearly made Jessica an outcast. She was forced to make concessions to the Sisterhood and allow them to test Paul when he came of age.

Despite her loyalties and love for the Bene Gesserit, Jessica proved to be very much her own creature. Ultimately, it seemed, her love for the Duke and their son, and her fealty to House Atreides, would prove stronger than her duty to the Sisterhood, a fact that would have far-reaching repercussions.



KWISATZ HADERACH IN WAITING

PAUL ATREIDES

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY:

6

People are the true strength of a Great House.

FAITH:

7

I must learn quickly to be worthy of my father's legacy.

JUSTICE:

4

POWER:

5

TRUTH:

8

There are problems in this universe for which there are no answers.

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE:

6

Shield Fighting, Short Blades

COMMUNICATE:

5

Charm

DISCIPLINE:

6

Precision, Self-control

MOVE:

5

Body Control

UNDERSTAND:

6

Imperial Politics

Traits: Noble Scion, Wise Beyond His Years, Destined for Greatness

TALENTS

- ☐ **Cool Under Pressure (Battle):** Paul may automatically succeed on a Battle skill test by spending 3 Threat (1 Determination).
- ☐ **Direct:** Once per scene, Paul may give an ally an extra action on his turn.
- ☐ **Prana-Bindu:** Paul may re-roll 1d20 on a Move or Discipline test.
- ☐ **The Slow Blade:** Paul may ignore an enemy asset in a duel or skirmish when he buys additional dice with Threat while making an attack.
- ☐ **Voice:** Paul may spend up to 3 points of Threat to buy automatic successes on a Communicate test (1 success/point).

The first and only child of Duke Leto Atreides and his concubine, the Bene Gesserit adept Lady Jessica, Paul was heir apparent to the Atreides dynasty. A boy of only fifteen, none could foresee how his destiny would shake the universe.

Paul's very existence was an issue of secret contention amongst the Bene Gesserit who had ordered his mother to bear a daughter for Duke Leto. Conceived and born during a turbulent time for the Atreides, Paul was raised with great love by his parents. Despite the dangerous political turmoil in which House Atreides was embroiled, Paul's childhood was sheltered from the worst dangers.

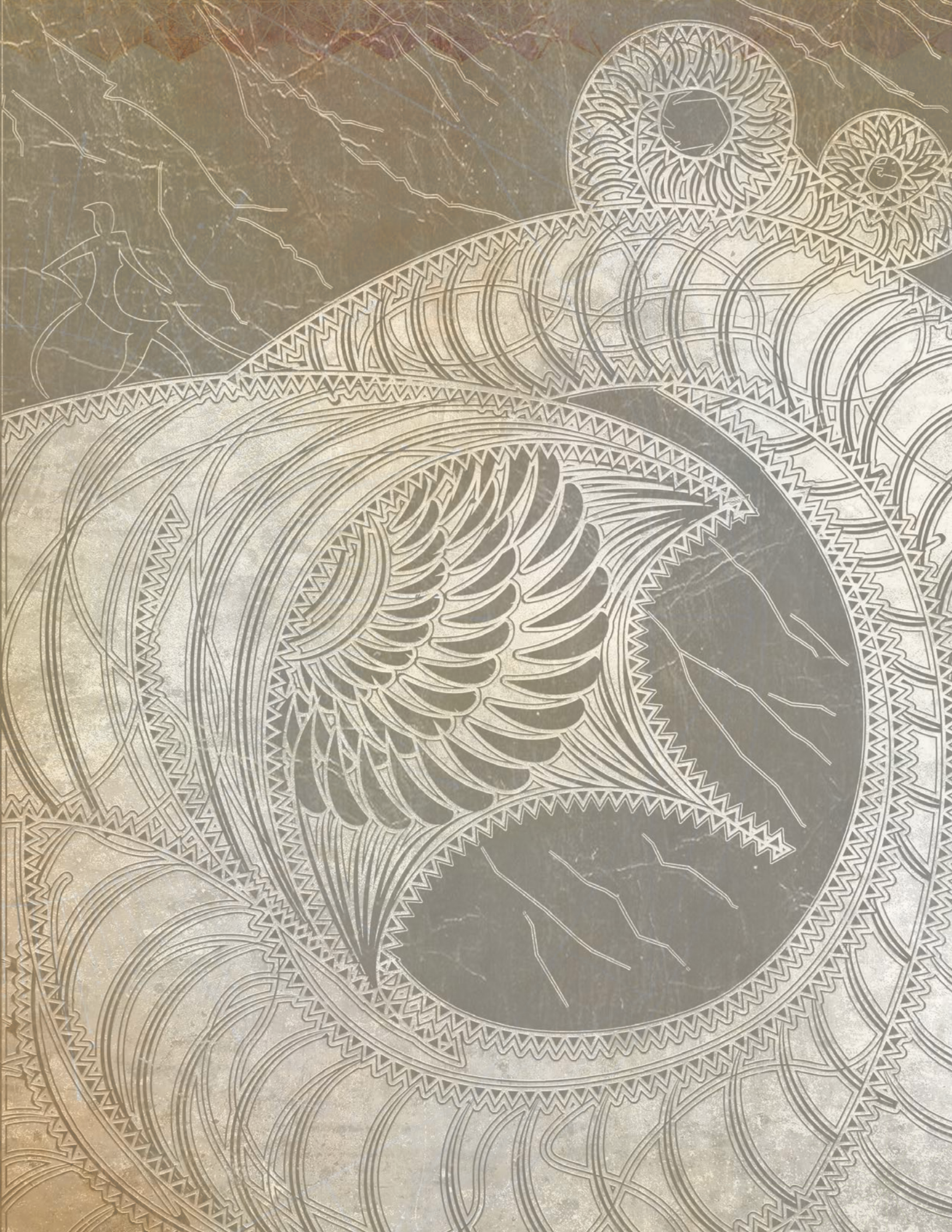
As he grew older, Paul received tutelage from the Atreides' trusted retainers. The Duke had gathered about him some of the greatest men of his age: the renowned swordmaster Duncan Idaho, the warrior-troubadour Gurney Halleck, and the Mentat Thufir Hawat, among others. These experts in their fields provided Paul a superlative education and he proved to be a fine student.

By the age of fifteen Paul Atreides had been groomed for greatness, not least by his mother. The Lady Jessica, though only an adept of the Bene Gesserit, sensed a great fate around her son. Knowing that Paul's birth interrupted generations of breeding plans by the Reverend Mothers, she suspected he might even be the fabled Kwisatz Haderach, the super-being that the Sisterhood sought to control for itself. Accordingly, she trained Paul in the mysteries of the Bene Gesserit, forgoing the usual order of instruction that he might be prepared for the dangerous times she foresaw. This decision was given grudging approval by the Reverend Mother Gaius Mohiam after she administered to Paul the dreaded gom jabbar.

When the Emperor ordered House Atreides to take control of Arrakis and the harvesting of spice, Paul was as prepared for what came next as any boy could possibly be. Though yet untested in command and combat, Paul bore all the makings of a great leader. From his father he'd learned a keen sense of justice and empathy, tempered with steely resolve. From his mother, an appreciation for political subtlety and the philosophies of the Bene Gesserit. His parents were as devoted to him as he was to them, and they gave him every possible advantage against the many dangers they foresaw in his future. Paul would one day rule House Atreides, and the Duke and his concubine knew that the greatest dangers imaginable would one day be his alone to face.

But Paul was still growing into manhood. He'd been groomed to follow in his father's footsteps but had not yet faced the hardest realities of leadership. He was not naïve, but he was inexperienced in the vicious maneuvering of the Imperial throne and the Houses of the Landsraad, to say nothing of the subtlest machinations of the Guild and Bene Gesserit.

At the beginning of the Arrakis Affair, Paul Atreides stood unknowingly at a nexus of events that would prove to change the very order of humanity itself. He had begun to have troubling dreams of a future in which he alone would make decisions with ramifications millennia in their unfolding.



WARRIOR TROUBADOUR GURNEY HALLECK

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY:

8

The Atreides have given me everything, I will do the same in return.

FAITH:

4

JUSTICE:

7

There's no justice but what we make ourselves.

POWER:

5

TRUTH:

6

Truth's a complex thing, but we know it when we see it.

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE:

8

Short Blades, Tactics

COMMUNICATE:

6

Music (Baliset)

DISCIPLINE:

7

Resolve

MOVE:

6

UNDERSTAND:

5

Traits: Warrior, Jongleur

TALENTS

- ❖ **Bolster:** Gurney can spend 2 Threat to allow an ally to re-roll their dice pool. They may use Gurney's Discipline instead of their skill.
- ❖ **The Reason I Fight (Duty):** When Gurney attempts a Battle test using the chosen drive, and the drive's statement aligns with the action being attempted, he may re-roll 1d20.
- ❖ **The Slow Blade:** Gurney may ignore an enemy asset in a duel or skirmish when he buys additional dice with Threat while making an attack.
- ❖ **Unquestionable Loyalty (House Atreides):** At the start of each adventure, Gurney begins with a pool of 3 Threat (equivalent to 1 Determination) which only he may use and which may only be used on an action in direct service to House Atreides.

The Warmaster of House Atreides, Gurney Halleck is one of the most reputed fighters in the Imperium, renowned for his prowess in combat and his equal skill as a poet and musician.

Born in the slave pits of Giedi Prime, Halleck knew a life of privation and suffering. His time under the Harkonnen boot left scars both in body and soul, but never broke his spirit. He still bears the scars of an inkvine lash across his jaw, and his own sister was murdered by the Harkonnens, an act he has never forgiven.

After his escape from Giedi Prime, Halleck became embroiled in conflicts involving House Vernius of Ix, eventually leading to his arrival on Caladan and his association with the Atreides. In time, his service to the Atreides became more than a matter of employ. Their just and noble ways touched him deeply, and he soon came to view the Duke and his family as his own.

Halleck was a man of contradictions. The hardness of his earlier life left him an ugly man, but his heart was filled with poetry. His skill with all manner of weapons was equaled by his mastery of the baliset and music. His ruthlessness against his enemies was matched only by the kindness he bore for those he loved.

Quick with an appropriate quotation or poem, Halleck became a close friend and mentor to the young Paul Atreides. He taught the young noble to fight with shield and kindjal and tutored him in the finer points of the arts. He saw young Paul as the son he never had and would willingly give his life for him, as he would for any of the Atreides.

In the days leading up to the Atreides investiture of Arrakis, Halleck was one of the key members of the Duke's war council, plotting strategy and tactics and doing everything possible to thwart the Harkonnens. In the years to come his loyalty would be tested and proven again and again.

SPYMASTER MENTAT THUFIR HAWAT

DRIVE STATEMENT

DUTY: **8** The protection of the Atreides is my reason to live.

FAITH: **4**

JUSTICE: **6** Right and wrong must be measured against my responsibilities.

POWER: **5**

TRUTH: **7** The primacy of my agenda is ruled only by fact.

SKILL FOCUSES

BATTLE: **6** Assassination, Strategy

COMMUNICATE: **5**

DISCIPLINE: **7** Observe

MOVE: **5**

UNDERSTAND: **8** Data Analysis, Deductive Reasoning, Imperial Politics, Kanly

Thufir Hawat's name rang out with respect and fear across the Imperium. One of the finest Mentats to ever live, Hawat was a trusted advisor to Duke Leto Atreides and a formidable opponent to their enemies.

Hawat had served the Atreides for three generations by the time of the Arrakis Affair. By the time Leto inherited the dukedom Hawat had established security protocols and a vast network of spies honed for over a century. Hawat's counsel was a large part of Leto's success in the following years, and the aged Mentat was a part of the Duke's trusted inner circle, as he had been for the dukes before him.

Hawat was an exceptionally talented Mentat, able to compute likely outcomes with a high degree of accuracy. His natural aptitude was enormous, but the breadth and depth of his intelligence network provided him an unparalleled quality of data from which he could operate. Hawat's spies were thought to be insinuated even amongst the intelligence operations of the Imperial House.

As the Atreides Master of Assassins, Hawat was instrumental in both counterespionage and the elimination of dangerous opposition elements. While the Atreides always took pains to abide by the formal rules of kanly in such disputes, Hawat's ruthlessness saw that the House rarely paid the price of abiding by the spirit of the law when their opponents did not. His love for the Atreides ensured that Hawat provided the most superlative service possible of a Mentat, extending even to the training of Paul Atreides in his dark arts.

Hawat's brilliance and bloody-minded attention to detail was the fist in the Atreides' velvet glove, a fact that their enemies frequently came to learn with regret.

Traits: Mentat, Insightful and Resourceful, Spymaster

TALENTS

- ☞ **Advisor (Understand):** Thufir may re-roll a single d20 in the dice pool of an ally he assists.
- ☞ **Cautious (Understand):** Thufir may re-roll a single d20 gained from spending Threat on an Understand skill test.
- ☞ **Mentat Discipline:** Thufir may add two automatic successes on all Understand tests he attempts when remembering facts or data.
- ☞ **Mind Palace:** Thufir may revisit a scene in his mind and attempt to Obtain Information.



LOYAL SWORDMASTER DUNCAN IDAHO

DRIVE STATEMENT

DUTY:	8	I will give my all for those I have sworn to protect.
FAITH:	7	The universe is vast, a man must find his own way.
JUSTICE:	6	My own word and oath are all I need to measure the deeds of others.
POWER:	4	
TRUTH:	5	

SKILL FOCUSES

BATTLE:	8	Long Blades
COMMUNICATE:	6	Charm
DISCIPLINE:	8	Resolve
MOVE:	6	Distance Running
UNDERSTAND:	5	

Traits: Charismatic Survivor, Ginaz Swordmaster

TALENTS

- ❖ **Bold (Battle):** Duncan may re-roll a d20 gained from spending Threat on a Battle skill test.
- ❖ **Driven:** After Duncan spends 3 Threat for 1 point of Determination, roll 1d20. If he rolls equal to or under his Discipline rating (by itself), he immediately regains those spent Threat.
- ❖ **Make Haste:** Duncan may choose to suffer one additional complication in a Move test to gain one automatic success. During any conflict, he may spend 1 Threat to take the first action, regardless of who would otherwise act first.
- ❖ **Master-at-Arms:** At the start of a duel, skirmish, or battle, Duncan can spend 1 point of Threat to increase a martial asset he has by +1 Quality for that conflict.

Swordmaster of House Atreides, Duncan Idaho was one of the finest warriors in the universe. Fiercely loyal to the Duke and his son, he was their bodyguard and trusted friend.

Brought up on Giedi Prime, Idaho was trained to be a prey animal, for the entertainment of Rabban Harkonnen, while Duncan was only a boy. However, he managed to escape certain death at the hands of his hunters and find his way to Caladan. When he saw how different the Atreides were from the brutal Harkonnens, he offered his undying loyalty to Duke Paulus. He showed such steadfast dedication to the Atreides, no matter what task was given to him, that Leto sent him for training with the Ginaz swordmasters, where he excelled.

In the years that followed Idaho proved himself time and again against the Atreides enemies, especially the hated Harkonnens. His deeds were many and fearsome, and he was well-liked by the people of Caladan and the other vassals of the House.

A notably handsome man, Idaho was also known for his many dalliances and love affairs. His reputation, good looks, and irreverent attitude made him a subject of popular attention. Despite this, his seriousness was never in question when it came to his duty. Notable among these duties was his service as fighting instructor, and eventually close friend, to the young Paul Atreides.

Despite his love of the Atreides, he never fully trusted the Lady Jessica. Though he had great affection for her, he privately worried that her ties to the Bene Gesserit might one day compel her against her family.

When Duke Leto accepted the fiefdom of Arrakis, Idaho was among the first envoys he sent to that planet. He hoped that the people of Dune might judge House Atreides on the strength of Idaho's character, and that the charismatic warrior might be instrumental in forging alliances that their House could count upon in the turbulent times that lay ahead.

RELUCTANT TRAITOR DR. WELLINGTON YUEH

DRIVE STATEMENT

DUTY:	4	
FAITH:	7	Who can believe in a greater power when evil is unavoidable?
JUSTICE:	8	My course of action is terrible, yet I must find a way to do right.
POWER:	5	
TRUTH:	6	I do not know what is true anymore, but I will act nonetheless.

SKILL FOCUSES

BATTLE:	4	
COMMUNICATE:	7	Deceit, Teaching
DISCIPLINE:	5	
MOVE:	4	
UNDERSTAND:	8	Genetics, Surgery

Traits: Suk Doctor, Despises the Harkonnens

TALENTS

- ☞ **Advisor (Understand):** Yueh may re-roll a single d20 in the dice pool of an ally he assists.
- ☞ **Imperial Conditioning:** Any attempt to coerce Yueh into harming a human automatically fails, and he automatically succeeds on any skill test to persuade another that he intends them no harm. Attempts by the Harkonnens are exempt from this talent as they have found Yueh's weakness — the safety of his wife Wanna.
- ☞ **Intense Study:** Once per scene, Yueh may use his Understand skill on a single skill test instead of any other skill, and he is counted as having a focus for that test.

Chief physician of House Atreides, Dr. Wellington Yueh was a trusted confidant, advisor, and friend to the inner circle of the Duke's family. He was also a man with a deadly secret.

A graduate of the Suk Inner School, Yueh served the Atreides for many years. He was a superlative medical practitioner and possessed of a kind manner, well-liked by the Duke's household. His modest demeanor made him more popular than many Suk doctors, often known for their arrogance and cold personalities. While Yueh carried himself with confidence and refined manners, he was nonetheless a gentle man who could be very charming when he felt himself to be in the company of friends.

Yueh was a subject of the Suk School's so-called Imperial conditioning, and therefore was incapable of causing the harm of another human being, and certainly not of those under his care. The diamond brand on his forehead assured all who saw it that Yueh was a doctor suitable to minister to the Emperor himself without risk of treachery.

When the Atreides took control of Arrakis, this was no longer true.

In fact, the twisted Mentat Piter de Vries of House Harkonnen had suborned Yueh in secret, years prior. The doctor's wife, Wanna, had fallen into the clutches of the Harkonnens, and through a combination of simple blackmail and subtle, psychological manipulation, de Vries accomplished the unthinkable: he broke Yueh's Suk conditioning.

When the Atreides left for Arrakis they carried with them the most reluctant of traitors-in-waiting. Yueh was wracked by the pressures of the likely futile chance to recover his wife, his hatred for the Harkonnens, and his guilt at knowing he would soon betray the people he respected most in the universe.

The results of Yueh's tortured psyche would have results surprising to all involved.



HOUSE HARKONNEN

HOUSE MAJOR



Homeworld: Giedi Prime

Other Holdings: Lankiveil, Arrakis (Governorship)

Banners and Arms: **Colors:** Red & Black
Crest: Sigil

House Traits: Brutal, Cunning

Primary Domains: Farming (Produce) – Spice (Current Governors of Arrakis)

Secondary Domains: Industrial (Produce) – Refined Alloys, Industrial (Produce) – Mass-produced Goods.

The name Harkonnen is synonymous with brutality, cruelty, and ambition. Among the great Houses of the Landsraad none are as feared and few are as envied as House Harkonnen.

The Harkonnens labored as a House Minor for many centuries, near-outcasts as the result of an ancient betrayal for which they have always blamed the Atréides. Only in comparatively recent times did the Harkonnens manage to gain the wealth and resources to become recognized as a Great House, an accomplishment soaked in blood and born of quiet betrayals.

Their capital and homeworld is the planet Giedi Prime. An industrialized world, the lower castes are held in slavery or near-slavery under the savage whip of Harkonnen rule. The Harkonnens and their associated noble families relished cruelty, and public bloodsports are a leading form of entertainment.

For decades, Siridar Baron Vladimir Harkonnen had been entrusted by the Emperor with the management of spice on the fiefdom of Arrakis (taking over from House Richese). There, the Baron and his family have crushed the planet's natives in order to squeeze every last milligram of spice wealth into their coffers. Few outside Arrakis really care how the people are treated as long as the spice flows.

Another House might be content to have control of the greatest source of wealth in the known universe, but not the Harkonnens. Baron Vladimir has many plans for himself and his dynasty to further their ambitions — ambitions for which they are capable of any act, no matter how terrible.

DEVIOUS NOBLE

SIRIDAR BARON VLADIMIR HARKONNEN

DRIVE STATEMENT

DUTY: **7** I am House Harkonnen, and I owe loyalty only to my House.

FAITH: **6** Faith's a fine thing insofar as it allows one to control one's inferiors.

JUSTICE: **4**

POWER: **8** What else is there in all of life but the pursuit of one's strength?

TRUTH: **5**

SKILL FOCUSES

BATTLE: **4** Strategy

COMMUNICATE: **6** Deceit

DISCIPLINE: **6** Espionage

MOVE: **4**

UNDERSTAND: **8** House Politics, Imperial Politics

Traits: Noble, Cunning and Cruel

TALENTS

- ☞ **Binding Promise:** The Baron may spend 1, 2, or 3 points of Threat to make an agreement binding. To break it, an opponent must spend twice this in Momentum.
- ☞ **Constantly Watching:** Whenever Baron Harkonnen attempts a test to detect danger or hidden enemies, he reduces the Difficulty by 2, to a minimum of 0. In addition, once per scene, he can increase the cost for an opponent to Keep the Initiative by +2.
- ☞ **Direct:** Once per scene, Baron Harkonnen can give an ally an extra action on his turn.
- ☞ **Subtle Words:** Baron Harkonnen can create a new trait whenever he spends Threat for extra dice on a Communicate test.

Siridar Baron Vladimir Harkonnen was one of the most feared, hated, and admired men in all the Imperium. From his home on Giedi Prime, the Baron ruled with an iron fist, sans velvet glove.

A corpulent and venal man, the Baron took great pleasure in the discomfort his appearance caused in others. So fat that he required a suspensor harness for mobility, Baron Harkonnen delighted in making his allies and rivals alike uncomfortable. As a younger man he took great pride in his body, until a virulent disease corrupted his hard work. The loss of his athletic physique remained a sore point to the Baron, although he hid this vanity to all but those who knew him well.

Baron Harkonnen was a man of brutal policies but was possessed of a subtle mind. Having raised his House to untold heights of power, his schemes and plots were multitudinous, some decades in the offing. He was a man who did not brook failure in his subordinates, and even his own heirs feared and hated him, a fact of which he was keenly aware and, indeed, encouraged. His closest confidant was the twisted Mentat Piter de Vries, chosen by the Baron precisely for his perverse and cynical mind. It was de Vries whom the Baron encouraged to play his nephews against one another to better control them. This cruelty in policy dripped down to every level of the House, and those that toiled under the Harkonnens suffered terribly.

It was the Baron's maneuvering that maintained House Harkonnen in control of Arrakis and the spice melange. The House's fortunes swelled under the Baron's rule, eclipsing every accomplishment of his forbearers. The wealth gained legitimately was only eclipsed by the embezzling and hoarding of spice that occurred under the Baron's direction.

The Baron's ambitions were not fulfilled through this wealth. It was his desire to see House Harkonnen rise to take the Imperial throne itself, a goal he set about achieving through the most complex of stratagems, utilizing his two nephews as willing pawns. With the aid of de Vries, the Baron set into motion a plan that would see the Atreides temporarily gain control of the precious fiefdom of Arrakis, but only that he might supplant and destroy them entirely, with the help of an Emperor whom he would soon after betray. The outcome of this plot would prove to be more complex than even the Baron himself could imagine.

TWISTED MENTAT

PITER DE VRIES

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY: **7** I serve the Baron in all things, but I am my own man.

FAITH: **5**

JUSTICE: **4**

POWER: **8** Domination is the only noble pursuit.

TRUTH: **6** Absolute truth is required when forging a more useful truth.

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE: **5** Assassination

COMMUNICATE: **5**

DISCIPLINE: **7**

MOVE: **5**

UNDERSTAND: **8** Data Analysis, House Politics, Imperial Politics

Piter de Vries was a vicious, sadistic, and brilliant Mentat, and perhaps the closest approximation of a friend to Baron Vladimir Harkonnen. A product of Bene Tleilax 'twisting', de Vries served as House Harkonnen's primary Mentat, working to further his master's ambitions.

Where standard Mentats are meticulously trained and conditioned to act without base emotion, de Vries' worst tendencies had all been encouraged. While he still possessed the razor-sharp insight of any other Mentat, he was prone to adding cruel flourishes to plans crafted from the output of his computations. This sadism was highly appealing to the Baron, who valued him greatly but never fully trusted him or considered him anything but expendable.

De Vries' greatest accomplishment was the breaking of Dr. Wellington Yueh's Suk conditioning in the furtherance of the Baron's agenda. Just how the Mentat accomplished this seemingly impossible feat remains poorly understood, but it is known he utilized the kidnapping of the doctor's wife as a psychological fulcrum against which his conditioning was shattered.

De Vries commanded an intelligence network to rival that of any power in the Imperium and schemed ceaselessly on behalf of the Harkonnens, and likely, himself. The extent of the evils he accomplished in his life can only be guessed.

Traits: Twisted Mentat, Killer

TALENTS

- ☐ **Advisor (Understand):** Piter may re-roll a single d20 in the dice pool of an ally he assists.
- ☐ **Driven:** After Piter spends Threat to gain the use of Determination, roll 1d20. If he rolls equal to or under his Discipline rating (by itself), he immediately regains that spent Threat.
- ☐ **Mentat Discipline:** Add two automatic successes on all Understand tests Piter attempts when remembering facts or data.
- ☐ **Twisted Mentat:** Piter gains 1 bonus point of Threat when he adds to Threat on an Understand test. He may only use this to Obtain Information, or to create a trait exploiting an opponent's weakness or causing pain and suffering.

ELEGANT KNIFE FIGHTER FEYD-RAUTHA

DRIVE STATEMENT

DUTY: **6** I serve the House because it will one day be mine.

FAITH: **7** I am the best at everything I do.

JUSTICE: **4**

POWER: **8** I deserve to have everything I want.

TRUTH: **5**

SKILL FOCUSES

BATTLE: **7** Short Blades

COMMUNICATE: **6** Intimidation, Listening

DISCIPLINE: **5**

MOVE: **7** Swift

UNDERSTAND: **6**

Traits: Duelist, Arrogant and Ruthless

TALENTS

- ☞ **Bold (Battle):** Feyd may re-roll a d20 gained from spending Threat on a Battle skill test.
- ☞ **Decisive Action:** After successfully removing an enemy asset with Battle, Feyd may remove a second enemy asset by spending 2 Threat.
- ☞ **Rapid Maneuver:** When attempting a skill test to reach a destination quickly when moving on foot or in a vehicle, Feyd can reduce the Difficulty by 1 for attempts to reach a destination quickly by any means. In a conflict, when Feyd moves an asset, he may move it an additional zone by spending 1 point of Threat.
- ☞ **The Reason I Fight (Power):** When Feyd attempts a Battle test using the chosen drive, and the drive's statement aligns with the action being attempted, he may re-roll 1d20.

- ☞ **The Slow Blade:** Feyd may ignore an enemy asset in a duel or skirmish when he buys additional dice with Threat while making an attack.

The favored protégé of Baron Harkonnen, Feyd was as beautiful as his mentor was repulsive, and as deadly as almost any man alive. The young noble was noted for a cruel streak surprising even by Harkonnen standards and was poised on the edge of greatness, in no small part due to his existence as another part of the far-ranging Bene Gesserit breeding program.

Of the baron's two nephews and chosen heirs, Feyd was the obvious favorite. The Baron's attraction to Feyd helped forgive many of his faults and indulge his desires. The young man was an accomplished fighter and gladiatorial combatant as a teenager and had already dispatched a great number of slaves in the arena before the age of 20. Feyd favored poisoned blades and was known to illustrate the effects of various toxins on his dying opponents for the entertainment of the audience. However, great care was always taken to ensure no gladiator slave stood a chance of actually winning, granting Feyd an inflated view of his combat skill.

While he lacked the experience of command, Feyd possessed a sharp mind, and was carefully tutored by the twisted Mentat Piter de Vries. The Baron himself took pains to educate young Feyd, seeing in the cruel young man a potential heir to not just the Harkonnen barony but to the Empire he hoped to soon control.



BRUTAL WARRIOR GLOSSU 'THE BEAST' RABBAN

DRIVE STATEMENT

DUTY: **6** Fear keeps subordinates in line.

FAITH: **7** I don't need to understand a plan to know it will benefit me.

JUSTICE: **4**

POWER: **8** I'm stronger so I'm better.

TRUTH: **5**

SKILL FOCUSES

BATTLE: **7** Lasgun

COMMUNICATE: **5** Intimidation

DISCIPLINE: **5**

MOVE: **6** Stealth

UNDERSTAND: **4**

The eldest of the two Rabban brothers, Glossu was as brutal as his sibling was sly. Infamous as a brute tyrant, Rabban was one of the most hated men of his time.

Having killed his father on their homeworld of Lankiveil, Rabban was taken under the wing of Baron Harkonnen who, lacking progeny of his own, saw that his nephews might suffice to become his heirs. Of the two, Rabban proved a useful tool for brutality but little else. The Baron tried to train him in the art of statecraft and subtle deception. However, Rabban never really understood the complexities of politics and often ruined a plan by taking direct action in an attempt to impress the Baron.

It wasn't long before Baron Vladimir turned his attention to Feyd, although Rabban failed to notice he was out of favor. This is mainly because the Baron granted him the governance of Arrakis. 'The Beast' brutalized the population of Arrakis, and the native Fremen in particular, for many years. He was too unwise to realize that this mismanagement was precisely what the Baron wanted, as it would allow Feyd to appear as a savior when he took over.

While the subtleties of his position escaped him, Rabban didn't really care. The governance of Arrakis allowed him opportunity for betrayal, revenge, and savagery, which is all he really wanted. Though he despised his cleverer younger brother, and failed to understand his uncle's subtle stratagems, Rabban was utterly dedicated to the Harkonnen cause, knowing that it would continue to give him endless opportunities to delight in violence.

Traits: Thuggish Tyrant, Brutal and Vicious

TALENTS

- ☉ **Bold (Battle):** Rabban may re-roll a d20 gained from spending Threat on a Battle skill test.
- ☉ **Make Haste:** Rabban may choose to suffer one additional complication in a Move test to gain one automatic success. During any conflict, he may spend 1 Threat to take the first action, regardless of who would otherwise act first.
- ☉ **Master-at-Arms:** At the start of a duel, skirmish, or battle, Rabban may spend 1 point of Threat to increase a martial asset he has by +1 Quality for that conflict.



HOUSE CORRINO

IMPERIAL (GREAT) HOUSE



Homeworld: Kaitain

Other Holdings: Salusa Secundus (Prison Planet)

Banners and Arms: **Colors:** Gold & Scarlet
Crest: Lion

House Traits: Imperial, Wealthy

Primary Domains: Military (Workers) – Sardaukar Soldiers

Secondary Domains: Several diverse interests in partnership with other houses as Imperial partner

The Imperial House and greatest of the Houses of the Landsraad, House Corrino has ruled the Known Universe for thousands of years. Mired in intrigues both internal and external, the Corrinos are ruthless and as addicted to power as they are to the spice.

House Corrino rose to power approximately ten thousand years ago, after a decisive victory at the Battle of Corrin, from which the House takes its name. Their household moved to their present throne-world, Kaitain, from their original homeworld of Salusa Secundus, which they maintained as a prison planet.

The Imperial House's grip on the Empire is absolute. Ruling through a combination of subtle political acumen and the strategic application of brute force, their supremacy has been unchallenged for an unthinkable era.

Corrino hegemony is maintained by the infamous Sardaukar, the premier fighting force of the entire Empire. The merest rumor of their deployment being sufficient to see belligerents seek terms of surrender, the Sardaukar are more than capable of seeing that House Corrino keeps their throne.

It is believed that only if all the Houses of the Landsraad were to join in opposition to House Corrino might they have a chance at defeating the Sardaukar. It is a notion the Corrinos take seriously, working tirelessly to sow division among allies and enemies alike.

PADISHAH EMPEROR SHADDAM IV

DRIVE STATEMENT

DUTY: **7** The crown lies heavy, but is made of gold.

FAITH: **4**

JUSTICE: **6** Lesser people must look to their superiors to know what is right.

POWER: **8** The universe belongs to me.

TRUTH: **5**

SKILL FOCUSES

BATTLE: **5**

COMMUNICATE: **6**

DISCIPLINE: **7** Command, Composure

MOVE: **5**

UNDERSTAND: **7** House Politics, Imperial Politics

Traits: Emperor of the Known Universe, Paranoid Schemer

TALENTS

- ☞ **Cautious (Communicate):** The Emperor may re-roll a single d20 gained from spending Threat on a Communicate skill test.
- ☞ **Collaboration (Understand):** The Emperor may spend 2 Threat to allow an ally to use his Understand skill as his own.
- ☞ **Constantly Watching:** Whenever the Emperor attempts a test to detect danger or hidden enemies, he reduces the Difficulty by 2, to a minimum of 0. In addition, once per scene, he can increase the cost for an opponent to Keep the Initiative by +2.
- ☞ **Rigorous Control:** The Emperor may use Discipline instead of any skill in an extended test. He reduces the requirement by 1 if the skill was already Discipline.

Shaddam Corrino IV, 81st Padishah Emperor of the known universe, rules the greatest empire ever known to humankind. The responsibilities and duties of wielding this enormous power are as burdensome to him as they were rewarding.

Father of five daughters by the Bene Gesserit sister Anirul, Shaddam is as concerned with his legacy as he was with ruling his Empire. Without a son, he requires a male heir by marriage to inherit the Empire. As a result, much of his time is spent in subtle intrigues with the lesser Houses of the Landsraad in order to not only find a suitable husband for his favored daughter, Irulan, but to ensure no other Houses might threaten Corrino.

Like all Corrinos, Shaddam is prone to baroque plans and a conspiratorial mindset. Shaddam feels threatened by the growing popularity and martial strength of Duke Leto of House Atreides. Privately, he is known to have admired Duke Leto and once saw in him a suitable heir, but his political analysis has convinced him that Leto is more of a threat than any other.

It is these obsessions that have led Shaddam to court the Baron Harkonnen, a man he finds loathsome, in order to secure what he hopes will be a suitable heir to his lineage and the legacy of his House. With the aid of his maternal cousin and oldest friend, the Count Hasimir Fenring, Shaddam has set in motion a plan to see the Atreides destroyed by the Harkonnens without revealing his direct involvement.



HEIR TO THE IMPERIUM PRINCESS IRULAN

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY:

8

My destiny was shaped for me, but I will choose how I meet it.

FAITH:

4

JUSTICE:

6

Justice is an ideal rarely attained.

POWER:

5

TRUTH:

7

History is recorded by a series of observers, none of whom is impartial.

The most beautiful and arguably the most perceptive of Shaddam IV's five daughters, Irulan was groomed from a young age to be a marriageable pawn in her father's schemes. Raised in the Imperial crèche, she was subject to all the intrigues of House Corrino from the moment of her birth.

Highly intelligent, but also proud and haughty, Irulan benefited from a superb education. Her interests in literary and historical writing would prove to be of aid to her over the course of her life, but she was also an initiate of the Bene Gesserit. Her mother, a Bene Gesserit of Hidden Rank, saw that Irulan was tutored in the Sisterhood's ways, but Irulan would prove to be only a moderately talented pupil and never rose above the rank of adept. Even so, she remained more loyal to the Sisterhood than her father in many cases.

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE:

4

COMMUNICATE:

6

Charm

DISCIPLINE:

5

Observe

MOVE:

6

Dance

UNDERSTAND:

7

Imperial Politics

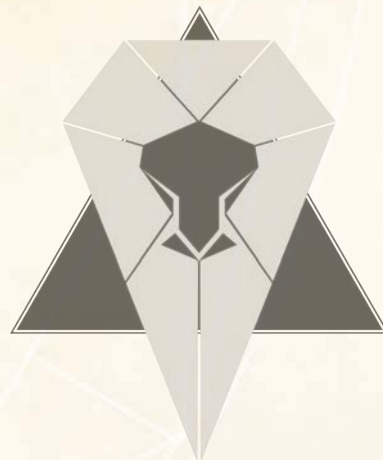
Irulan's relationship with her family was quietly strife-filled. Rivalries and intrigue abounded between the royal sisters, and even their parents. Like all her siblings, she was tutored in the means of detecting, and perhaps administering, chaumas and chaumurky. Plots of many kinds were a fundamental part of her life and left her mistrustful and cynical.

While Irulan was well-suited to the role her father intended for her, she also had an independent streak, accompanied by a sharp mind. This, combined with her immersion in conspiracy from a young age, left the young princess able to outmaneuver even her father from time to time.

Traits: Princess, Academic, Bene Gesserit

TALENTS

- ☞ **Intense Study:** Once per scene, Irulan may use her Understand skill on a single skill test instead of any other skill, and she is counted as having a focus for that test.
- ☞ **Masterful Innuendo:** Irulan may conceal a hidden message in a conversation by adding 1 to the Difficulty of the Communicate test.
- ☞ **Prana-Bindu:** Irulan may re-roll 1d20 on a Move or Discipline test.



IMPERIAL TRUTHSAYER

REVEREND MOTHER

GAIUS HELEN MOHIAM

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY: **8** I know my place in our plan.

FAITH: **7** The mystery of life isn't a problem to solve, but a reality to experience.

JUSTICE: **6** People should get what they deserve.

POWER: **5**

TRUTH: **4**

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE: **5**

COMMUNICATE: **7** Deceit

DISCIPLINE: **7** Observe

MOVE: **5**

UNDERSTAND: **7** Imperial Politics

Traits: Bene Gesserit, Reverend Mother, Truthsayer

TALENTS

- ✧ **Advisor (Communicate):** The Reverend Mother may re-roll a single d20 in the dice pool of an ally she assists.
- ✧ **Cool Under Pressure (Understand):** The Reverend Mother may spend 3 Threat (1 Determination) on to automatically succeed at an Understand test.
- ✧ **Hyperawareness:** Whenever the Reverend Mother spends Threat (Momentum) to Obtain Information she may ask two questions for each point spent. Further, the limits of what others would be able to notice do not apply to her.
- ✧ **Other Memory:** The Reverend Mother may remember things from years before she was born through this ability.
- ✧ **Passive Scrutiny:** When the Reverend Mother enters a scene, she may ask one question of the gamemaster as if she'd spent Threat to Obtain Information.

✧ **Prana-Bindu:** The Reverend Mother may re-roll 1d20 on a Move or Discipline test.

✧ **Voice:** The Reverend Mother may spend up to 3 points of Threat to buy automatic successes on a Communicate test (1 success/point).

Truthsayer to the Emperor, the Reverend Mother Gaius Helen Mohiam epitomized what it meant to be a Bene Gesserit. Aged but not frail, Mohiam was a powerful woman in every way conceivable.

A product and progenitor of the Bene Gesserit breeding program, Mohiam was steeped in the Sisterhood's ways from the time of her birth. As a young woman she had been instrumental in furthering their plans, birthing nine children by fathers of the Sisterhood's choosing (including Baron Vladimir Harkonnen). She was a master of prana-bindu and a full Reverend Mother, having successfully transmuted the Water of Life.

Notably, Mohiam possessed the full Bene Gesserit truthsense. Her ability to interpret another's intentions and drives was unparalleled, and paired with her staggering intellect, she rose quickly through the ranks of the Sisterhood.

At the time of the Arrakis Affair, Mohiam has been elevated to the Imperial court where she serves as the Emperor's personal Truthsayer. Though she is a dedicated servant of Shaddam IV, she never wavers from her commitments to the Bene Gesserit. Her role as Imperial Truthsayer affords her and the Sisterhood access to vital intelligence with which they might advance their own plans. Mohiam is utterly dedicated to the Bene Gesserit, and willing to do anything in their service.

COURTIER ASSASIN COUNT HASIMIR FENRING

DRIVE STATEMENT

DUTY: **7** What is expected of me is the least of my obligations.

FAITH: **4**

JUSTICE: **6** Law is the concern of lawyers and victims.

POWER: **8** I do as I please.

TRUTH: **5**

SKILL FOCUSES

BATTLE: **7** Assassination

COMMUNICATE: **6**

DISCIPLINE: **6** Command

MOVE: **8** Stealth

UNDERSTAND: **6** Poison

Traits: Noble Courtier, Assassin, Psychopath

TALENTS

- ☞ **Advisor (Battle):** Fenring may re-roll a single d20 in the dice pool of an ally he assists.
- ☞ **Hidden Motives:** When an opponent fails an Understand or Communicate test against Fenring, he may immediately create a trait which reflects a mistaken belief they have about him.
- ☞ **Passive Scrutiny:** When Count Fenring enters a scene, he knows one hidden or concealed piece of information about the situation or the player characters as if he'd spent Threat to Obtain Information.
- ☞ **Subtle Step:** When Fenring attempts a Move test to sneak through an area, or to move an asset subtly during a conflict, the first extra d20 he purchases for the test is free.

☞ **Subtle Words:** Fenring may create a new trait whenever he spends Threat for extra dice on a Communicate test.

☞ **To Fight Someone Is to Know Them (Understand):** Fenring adds 2 points to Threat when he defeats an enemy using the Understand skill. He may use them to Obtain information or create a trait about that enemy.

Supremely deadly, the courtier-assassin Count Hasimir Fenring was the closest confidant of Emperor Shaddam IV. The Count was a small, unassuming man, and easily underestimated — a persona he carefully cultivated.

A distant cousin to the Emperor, Fenring was Shaddam's only real childhood friend. Despite his status as a genetic eunuch — or perhaps because of it — the Bene Gesserit maneuvered him into the confidence of the Emperor. The two men grew to have a genuine friendship, and no other individual enjoyed such trust from the Emperor. They participated in so many plots and even assassinations together that Shaddam eventually feared Fenring might not keep all their secrets. Upon Shaddam's ascension, Fenring was rewarded with a marriage to the Bene Gesserit adept Lady Margot, and a position as Imperial Observer on Arrakis.

Fenring served the Emperor as an advisor and an emissary in delicate political matters. It was widely believed that Fenring also operates as an assassin in the Imperial House's constant political intrigues, but little proof exists. Even less proof can be found of the accusation that Fenring was responsible for the previous emperor's death by poisoning.

The Count is known for a stammer and other verbal tics which makes him frustrating in conversation. In fact, Fenring's mannerisms are all conscious choices. Those who are aware of his full reputation noted the Count's disposition as troubling. Baron Vladimir Harkonnen once described him as "a killer with the manners of a rabbit... the most dangerous kind."

Fenring is often found at the Imperial court but has been known to turn up in unexpected places, acting as the Emperor's eyes and ears, and occasionally delivering messages on behalf of his Emperor and friend.

THE FREMEN

FREMEN NAIB STILGAR

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY:

7

The tribe's life is my own.

FAITH:

8

Shai-Hulud shows us the way.

JUSTICE:

6

Harsh laws are needed in a harsh world, but we must know mercy in all its forms.

POWER:

4

TRUTH:

5

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE:

7

Short Blades

COMMUNICATE:

5

Intimidation

DISCIPLINE:

7

Command

MOVE:

6

Worm Rider

UNDERSTAND:

5

Traits: Fremen Leader, Fierce and Dedicated

TALENTS

- ☐ **Cautious (Battle):** Stilgar may re-roll a single d20 gained from spending Threat on a Battle skill test.
- ☐ **Cool Under Pressure (Move):** Stilgar may spend 3 Threat (1 Determination) to automatically succeed at a Move skill test.
- ☐ **Deliberate Motion:** When Stilgar attempts a Move test, he may spend Threat to ignore some or all Move-related complications at 1 point per complication ignored.
- ☐ **Rigorous Control:** Stilgar may use Discipline instead of any skill in an extended test. He reduces the requirement by 1 if the skill was already Discipline.
- ☐ **To Fight Someone Is to Know Them (Battle):** Stilgar adds to 2 points to Threat when he defeats an enemy using the Battle skill. He may use them to Obtain Information or create a trait about that enemy.

The naib of Sietch Tabr, Stilgar was among the most respected of the Fremmen of Arrakis. He was noted for his wisdom and pragmatism as a leader and led his people unflinchingly in times of great peril.

As a youth, Stilgar was nearly killed by Harkonnen soldiers and saved only thanks to the actions of Pardot Kynes, then Imperial Planetologist. It was Stilgar's testimony to his tribe that saved Kynes' life as an intruder in Fremmen territory, and he soon became a believer in the planetologist's vision of a verdant Arrakis. In the years that followed, Stilgar would become the naib of Sietch Tabr and a friend to Pardot Kynes' child, Liet.

The life of the Fremmen was harsh and Stilgar could be uncompromising as a leader, but he was noted for his sense of justice and love for his people. Under his leadership Sietch Tabr thrived even under the depredations of the Harkonnens. And always, Stilgar sought to bind the needs of his tribe with Liet's vision of the future. Stilgar was instrumental in the initial stages of the slow process of conserving sufficient water to truly change the face of Arrakis.

Like most Fremmen Stilgar was a deeply spiritual man, but he saw no contradiction in the prophecies of his people and Kynes' scientific plans. He was utterly dedicated to the liberation of the Fremmen by any means necessary.

FREMEN WARRIOR CHANI KYNES

DRIVE STATEMENT

DUTY: **6** I am but one Fremen, but I owe all to them as they owe all to me.

FAITH: **8** The Faithful will be rewarded with ennobling struggle.

JUSTICE: **7** Justice and Faith are inextricable.

POWER: **4**

TRUTH: **5**

A young woman of Sietch Tabr, Chani was a consummate Fremen. Little more than a teenager by the standards of the Faufreluches, she was already an accomplished warrior among her people as required of all among them at her age.

The daughter of the Imperial Planetologist, Liet Kynes, and Liet's Fremen wife, Faroula, Chani was raised as a full member of her Fremen tribe. A sandrider, killer of Harkonnens, and dedicated member of her sietch, Chani was as respected as any Fremen in Sietch Tabr. Like all Fremen, she was pragmatic and ruthless when need be, but also kind and loving when survival permitted.

SKILL FOCUSES

BATTLE: **6** Short Blades

COMMUNICATE: **5**

DISCIPLINE: **7**

MOVE: **6** Stealth

UNDERSTAND: **5** Religion (Fremen)

As the daughter of Liet, Chani was a great proponent of the planetologist's plans for the transformation of Arrakis. Her Faith in Fremen ways married perfectly to this ecological dream, and she worked tirelessly in its realization. She had great conviction in the Fremen Faith and was already on the path to becoming a sayyadina of her tribe as a teenager.

Chani was a lethal fighter as well, having led retributive raids against the Harkonnens on numerous occasions. Slight of build, almost elfin, she possessed great skill with the crysknife and was accomplished in the ways of stealth and ambush. Naib Stilgar saw greatness in her and trusted her as a close companion.

Traits: Fremen, Warrior

TALENTS

- ❖ **Bold (Move):** Chani may re-roll a d20 gained from spending Threat on a Move skill test.
- ❖ **Deliberate Motion:** When Chani attempts a Move test, she may spend Threat (Momentum) to ignore some or all Move-related complications at 1 point per complication ignored.
- ❖ **Subtle Step:** When Chani attempts a Move test to sneak through an area, or to move an asset subtly during a conflict, the first extra d20 she purchases for the test is free.
- ❖ **The Reason I Fight (Faith):** When Chani attempts a Battle test using Faith, and the related drive statement aligns with the action being attempted, she may re-roll 1d20.

IMPERIAL PLANETOLOGIST LIET KYNES

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY:

6

I owe the Emperor my allegiance but the Fremen my life.

FAITH:

8

The desert will provide the Faithful with what they need.

JUSTICE:

5

POWER:

4

TRUTH:

7

Fact cannot be obscured, only confused.

It was said that Liet Kynes served two masters: the Emperor and Shai-Hulud. In truth, Kynes was dedicated only to the Fremen and their dreams of Arrakis as paradise.

Born to Pardot Kynes and his Fremen wife, Liet inherited Pardot's position as Imperial Planetologist. Liet was raised with Pardot's visions of ecological transformation, but as a child of the Fremen Liet adopted their ways. Where the senior Kynes was concerned only with scientific rigor, Liet was as devoted to the Fremen as people and not simply willing field assistants.

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE:

5

COMMUNICATE:

6

DISCIPLINE:

7

Survival (Desert)

MOVE:

4

UNDERSTAND:

7

Botany, Ecology

As an adult, Liet spent as little time in the city of Arrakeen as possible, preferring the company of the Fremen and scientific pursuits to the politics of the city. The planetologist's work as an Imperial servant was an inconvenient necessity, and Liet made no friends among the ruling Harkonnens in this work. Liet took a Fremen spouse, and together had a daughter, Chani.

It was this perceived impartiality that led to the Emperor naming Liet Judge of the Change and overseer of the transition from Harkonnen rule to Atrides. Kynes despised the Harkonnens and expected little better from the Atrides. Kynes' only concern was the wellbeing of the Fremen and their generational work to make Arrakis a world of plenty.

Traits: Fremen, Planetologist

TALENTS

- ☞ **Cautious (Understand):** Kynes may re-roll a single d20 gained from spending Threat on an Understand skill test.
- ☞ **Collaboration (Understand):** Kynes may spend 2 Threat to allow an ally to use her Understand skill as their own.
- ☞ **Unquestionable Loyalty:** At the start of each adventure, Liet Kynes begins with 3 Threat, which only she may use, and which may only be used on an action in direct service to the Fremen.

CREATING NON-PLAYER CHARACTERS

Non-player characters make a world richer and bring more excitement to the story. Though as a gamemaster you do not need to go too in-depth into their creation, it would help for you to understand their backgrounds to express their intentions and act out their motives. As mentioned earlier, there are three types of non-player characters: **major**, **notable**, and **minor**. Some non-player characters may not fit into those categories but appear for moments in the game to give players a bit of context in certain situations or provide assistance. Here we will go through different ways of inserting non-player characters into the story and making them interesting to the players.

MAKE THEM BELIEVABLE

Everyone has motivations and needs, hopes, and dreams. People aspire to different goals — sometimes they align with other characters in the world, other times, not as much. When making a non-player character, consider what makes them interesting. Think about the people in your own life. Maybe you have an ambitious coworker who enjoys sucking up to the boss. Or maybe you cross paths with the same person on your commute to work every day.

For **major** and **notable** non-player characters, ask yourself questions about who they could be and how they got to the position of power that they're in now. Since these characters are more prominent in the game, start with the basic questions:

- ❖ What is their position? Are they a House ruler, or are they at the same position of power as the player characters?
- ❖ What is their name and what are their pronouns? Pronouns help show one aspect of a character's identity, before we dive deeper into their other facets.
- ❖ Where do they live? This could give you insight into their habits and the cultural norms that they have adopted.
- ❖ Have they lived there all their life? If not, this could be a good opportunity to see how they feel about moving and how it shapes their identity.

From there, think about what their motivations are and what is a valuable resource to them, taking into consideration their environment. This can go hand-in-hand when thinking about building out the details of the setting that you are building.

- ❖ What is considered most valuable in their environment/society? Is it water, or spice, or something else? How rich is the character in terms of the valuable resource?

- ❖ Does the character value power? Do they value wealth? Or maybe they are more interested in the protection of their community?
- ❖ Is there someone in their life that they care about more than power or wealth? Perhaps this is a relationship partner, a parent, or a child in their family? In some instances, it could even be a pet.
- ❖ What sacrifices have they made to get to this position? Maybe they will do anything for their community, willing to sacrifice even those they love? Or maybe they have killed over control of the spice trade?

Motivations and power can act as a double-edged sword. Though a non-player character can have a lot of power, they can be crushed under the pressures of societal expectations, or the expectations that they have put upon themselves. This can expose itself in gameplay in many ways. Maybe the character has a short temper, or they're wracked with guilt and often hide indoors, barely exposing themselves in public view. Think about their weaknesses and what makes them vulnerable. Here are a few questions that you can pick and choose from to get you started:

- ❖ Why do the people around the character fear them?
- ❖ Why does the character fail to communicate their commands properly to those around them?
- ❖ Why do the rest of the citizens hardly ever see the character?
- ❖ Why does no one seem to believe the character, despite their best intentions?
- ❖ What was something that the character did recently that caused political tension?

For a lighter tone, it could be interesting to think about what a non-player character's quirks are. These are not limited to just major or notable non-player characters but can be used for minor non-player characters as well. Quirks make room for humor in a game, especially when a session seems to be taking a moodier tone and you would like to break up the atmospheric tension. They also create more relatable characters that parallel with the personalities we see in our day-to-day lives. Here are a few questions to pick and choose from that you can answer for your non-player characters:

- ❖ What are they like around other characters? Are they shy and quiet or expressive and passionate? Or maybe they are indifferent, until they realize a character has something that they want?

- ⊗ Is there a personality type that they tend to have an affinity toward? Maybe they prefer being around louder, more boisterous characters, or maybe they tend to open up more around quiet, more thoughtful characters.
- ⊗ Do they have a very specific pet peeve? Maybe they always need to keep their stillsuit hanging up and they get annoyed when they see others lying theirs on the floor.
- ⊗ Do they have a hobby outside of their job? Maybe it's sculpting or weaving or some other art.

Minor non-player characters do not need as much detail as major or notable non-player characters, but can require a bit of a personal touch, so players can feel invested. They usually act as a threat to the player characters but act more as obstacles than a named villain. Though minor non-player characters are unnamed, they can still slip in a bit of context for the player characters. Maybe the player characters overhear two soldiers chatting, before they sneak into an enemy base. Or maybe it's a smuggler who is nervously reciting back a distrans to himself on what the next shipment will be. Here are some questions you can ask yourself when you prepare for an encounter like this with the player characters:

- ⊗ What are the minor non-player characters trying to do?
- ⊗ How much do they want to be here? Would they rather be at home and not face any danger at all, if

given an excuse? Or would they die for the job that they have signed up for?

- ⊗ Before the player characters attempt to fight, sneak past, or incapacitate the characters, what bit of information do they drop to the player characters?
- ⊗ If they do not fight back, how would they try to negotiate or communicate with the player characters?

Once you've written up some details, answering a few questions here and there, you should have a non-player character that is both engaging and believable enough for players to feel invested in interacting with them. Remember, these details that you have filled out are for you to process before stepping into the mind of the character, and they do not need to be perfect. The players do not need to know every single detail, but the exercise of filling out the details should help you deepen your understanding of the character before you act them out.

At the table, it's up to you to decide which parts of the character's personality and background you'd like to show. And as always, the goal is to have fun and enjoy the narrative that you are building together, so there is no pressure in trying to perfectly emulate any of the characters.

MANAGE DIVERSITY

The world of *Dune* is vast and large, filled with unique characters that have different needs. Embrace that diversity and make it apparent in your game, without



relying on two-dimensional tropes. Focus on a character's motivations and their wants and needs. A Fremen warrior character might make sacrifices for their sietch, but they are more than just a heartless fighter. Breathe life into that character by touching on a hobby they might have or a familiar quirk that can feel relatable to the players. Keep in mind that even a warrior has other things going on in their lives that can make them feel emotional. Show those vulnerable sides!

Be sure to include characters that look different from one another, who have different cultures and religious backgrounds, like how we function in the real world. Think about a time you went to a friend's house. Maybe they asked you to take your shoes off, or maybe they were a shoes-on type of household. Doing what your friend asked you to do is not only a sign of respect, but a sign of caring. The same goes for the non-player characters the players might encounter — someone from Caladan would consider spitting as a sign of rudeness, whereas someone from Arrakis might consider it as a sign of great honor.

Though it is good to integrate these differences, try to avoid stereotypes. For example, a character with a disability is not solely defined by that disability, because they have several other facets that make up their personality and background. Maybe they enjoy gossiping, with an abundant knowledge of all the rumors in their area, or maybe they are a stealthy escape artist, able to sneak past any guards in the way.

Additionally, a way to avoid stereotyping is to inject this diversity in every level of society, not just one. A Mentat character who is a wealthy woman working for a House would not be the same as a smuggler character who is a woman distributing illegal goods at the marketplace. Though some of their experiences as women might parallel one another, they are not entirely the same. This is one of the occasions where many possibilities exist and limiting a character to just one trope can leave the players feeling like they might have missed out on the larger picture.

Some other things that are good to keep in mind are:

- ✧ Replicating accents that are not your own might dampen the mood of the game (and make your players a little confused). Instead, try changing the pitch of your voice or the speed at which you're talking when acting as different characters. A nervous House guard might talk faster at a higher pitch with a more rushed tone than a laidback Bene Gesserit Agent, who knows how to remain calm in the face of danger.
- ✧ If you would like to include the use of different languages in the game, instead of attempting to speak a made-up version of the language, stick to English or the language that you, as a group, have chosen to use at the table, so that everyone as players can understand one another. As characters, they might be missing bits and pieces of information, but you can try to find ways to bridge that communication. Let the players know that their characters would not know certain things, but maybe they discover what is happening through a non-player character. Treat it similarly to if you were attempting to eavesdrop into a conversation behind a wall, only catching pieces of the overall context.
- ✧ Sexuality and romance can also look different between characters. Who are they attracted to, if anyone? Do they have one partner, multiple partners, or no partners at all? These are aspects that you can also fill into your characters' identities without reducing them to one trope and can also build out what the community around them looks like. Do they have a disapproving family? Do they have a secret partner? Are they in a community where they feel okay with showing their sexuality?
- ✧ Include different people of color! There should be representation for Black characters, Indigenous characters, and other people of color, since it reflects how the real world looks too. Don't be afraid to introduce characters that look different from the players. This will make the world richer and easier to play in. However, when describing them, try not to use words that might dehumanize them, even if they are non-player characters. Get to the point and avoid language that compares anyone to inanimate objects.
- ✧ Talking about the different religions in the *Dune* universe, especially on Arrakis, gives players different perspectives of the world. It also provides clarity into why some non-player characters have certain cultural practices. For example, Shai-Hulud takes on the form of a sandworm because of the sandworm's relationship with spice and the environment. Understanding the religion, culture, and environment grants players insight into how to interact with non-player characters.
- ✧ If you are using non-player characters that initially feel unfamiliar to the player characters culturally, or even if you are including a language barrier, make sure the character is relatable with realistic needs, wants, and personalities that players can understand, so they do not feel exoticized. Keep them grounded in reality, by showing off what the non-player character is most excited about. Maybe they have just graduated the Mentat school and they are working on some interesting new studies, or maybe they have been assigned a new task by the Bene Gesserit Sisterhood to infiltrate a secret base, or maybe they just went on a first date! Despite any kind of training that the character might have, it is okay for them to show parts of themselves to the players so that the table can understand what lies behind their motivations.

- ✧ Use pronouns to your advantage! This can show the players the different characters that you are playing with and help them gain insight into their identities.
- ✧ Need some help trying to come up with names? Look for a name generator and edit the names that come up as you need to.

Chances are you will be playing this game with people who are not exactly like you. Be mindful of differences at the table and think about how you can support the players in creating an engaging story. Though you have the power to direct the players through an outline that you have planned, the story should feel like it belongs to everyone. Encourage the use of safety tools (see **Chapter 8: Gamemastering**) and make sure that everyone feels comfortable with stopping in the middle of the scene if they need to rewind and redo something that does not fit with what they want from the game. If players do not feel comfortable engaging in a topic, acknowledge it, change the topic, and move on.

DON'T LET THEM TAKE OVER THE ADVENTURE

Even though you will be taking the time to fill in several details about the non-player characters, these details are more for you than they are for the player, so that you can process them and really step into the character's shoes. Condense what you know about the non-player characters into manageable chunks so that the players get to see facets of their personalities shine through. Instead of overloading the players with what the character had for breakfast, give them snippets of details that the players would find important or engaging to mesh with the story. What you show the players will make it easier for them to interact with the character, encouraging players to go on missions or dig deeper for more information.

Try to keep the focus on the player characters. The non-player characters should probably not hold the spotlight longer than the player characters. Instead, non-player characters should be guiding the player characters and attempting to lead them down exciting paths of the story. When you're interacting with player characters, here are some ways that a non-player character can support a player character's story and lead them to interesting plot points that you may have already set up:

- ✧ Introduce player characters to problems that only they have the solution for. You might have outcomes pre-planned for when players decide to go one way versus another. Just remember there is no right or wrong answer. Instead, focus on creating a fun story that can make room for fun and strange solutions.
- ✧ The non-player characters can act as guides or messengers to keep players on track, but if the player characters decide to go off-course, that's okay too! Just make sure that everyone at the table is okay with the way things are going and if you need to, use the non-player character to steer the players back to the plot points you want to hit.
- ✧ Placing non-player characters in difficult situations (within the safety of the pre-established lines that the players have already discussed) for the player characters to save them is one way of giving player characters agency. Maybe a non-player character is slipping off the edge of a cliff and only one of the player characters is close enough to save them. Or maybe the player characters are escaping from bandits, and the non-player character who has tagged along is falling behind.
- ✧ Let the presence of a non-player character generate questions for you to ask the player characters. These questions could be triggered by the character attempting to make a connection with the player characters. For example, you tell one of the player characters that a character they have just met, Ani, reminds them of their mother. Questions could include: "What is a memory you have of your mother?" "How does Ani remind you of your mother?" "How does that color your perception of Ani?" Questions not only allow players to create their own context, they can also drive tension between characters.
- ✧ If a player gets stumped on what to do, let the non-player character drop some hints. Maybe they overheard a bit of gossip about a location of spice thieves and raiders, or perhaps there's a hidden entrance into a secret Teilaxu laboratory.
- ✧ If an opportunity arises where a player character can influence a pivotal moment in the storyline, let them! Use the non-player characters to guide them there, without letting the non-player characters take charge of the moment.

Overall, remember that the player characters are the main characters in the story. How they interact and engage with the non-player characters and the world that you are guiding them through is what makes the narrative engaging. Shine the spotlight on player characters and give them opportunities to act and react to their surroundings. Sometimes you might be thrown a plot twist that even you were not expecting! Assuming everyone agrees to the new twist, it might be even more exciting than what you were planning. Keep an open mind, play it out, and see where it leads the story, while using the non-player characters to maintain the original plot framework that you had created.

DON'T CROSS THE LINE

Creating a villain is similar to creating a major or notable character, but their wants do not necessarily align with the wants of the world they inhabit. Although villains have motivations much like any other character, they are taking a more extreme approach when handling situa-